SHAWN TAVARES

Cloud Infrastructure & Security Engineer | Noltec

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SUMMARY

I'm an independent systems engineer based in Leamington, Ontario, serving Windsor-Essex and working remotely. I have a decade+ in IT, the last several in enterprise systems engineering, and today I manage 23,000 Windows and 8,000 iOS devices on Azure, Entra ID, Intune and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint. You work with me directly, from first call to finished build. No layers. No handoffs.

WHAT I WORK ON

- **Identity & access:** Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Active Directory, ADFS-to-cloud migration, enterprise applications and IdP configuration, Application Proxy
- **Endpoint management:** Microsoft Intune (configuration and compliance), Windows Autopilot, SCCM, Group Policy; Windows, iOS and macOS
- **Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Attack Surface Reduction (ASR), web indicators, Netskope, Zscaler, PKI
- **Azure & infrastructure:** Azure infrastructure, Azure Virtual Desktop, Nerdio, Teradici, Azure Arc Update Management, Azure IaaS/PaaS, Windows and Linux Server, VMware ESXi, SAN
- **Automation:** PowerShell and Microsoft Graph for deployment, remediation and day-to-day operations

EXPERIENCE

Systems Engineer · Greater Essex County District School Board

October 2022 – Present

- Manage 23,000 Windows and 8,000 iOS devices, plus macOS, with Intune configuration and compliance policies; built a PowerShell deployment that lets technicians upload hardware hashes to Autopilot automatically.
- Renewed the root CAs and redeployed certificates to all production servers, workstations and users.
- Implemented Microsoft Defender for Endpoint with web indicators and ASR rules; deployed Netskope and Zscaler.
- Design and maintain Entra ID Conditional Access policies.
- Migrated applications and users from ADFS to cloud-based authentication in Azure; built custom internal Azure applications published through Application Proxy.
- Manage Azure enterprise applications, IdP and Azure Virtual Desktop configuration, and user and file share permissions.
- Keep critical servers current on software and OS; rolled out Azure Arc Update Management for automated patching.
- Automate Intune, Entra ID and device tasks with PowerShell and Microsoft Graph. Toolkit: github.com/shawnptavares/powershell-toolkit

Client Systems Architect · Greater Essex County District School Board

October 2020 – October 2022

- Built the Azure Virtual Desktop environment in a couple of weeks and maintained it as a cost-saving option for higher-end technology needs; automated it with Nerdio and integrated Teradici with Nerdio Manager.
- Implemented ASR rules board-wide through Microsoft Defender; managed Azure AD and Active Directory.
- Built and tested SCCM/Intune packages for board devices; kept task sequences current (apps, drivers, Windows builds).
- Managed Group Policy for on-premises devices and configuration policies for Intune devices.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts for security remediations, application deployments, registry changes and more.
- Maintained server hardware and services for 72 schools; assisted the Systems Engineer with the SAN rebuild at the disaster recovery site (ESXi networking and SAN).
- Tested cloud and on-premises applications and assessed their value for management.
- Managed PaperCut for all staff and students, including monthly allotments and adding new Xerox devices.
- Wrote technician and end-user documentation; worked with the Network and Cyber Security teams.

EDUCATION

Niagara College · Welland, Ontario

Diploma, Computer Systems Technician – Networking and Cloud Technologies · Certificate, Pre-Technology

In progress: Microsoft Azure Administrator (AZ-104)